

International Rescue Committee (IRC) Somalia*_Kenya_2025-26_3-Month Report

Fellowship Organization

International Rescue Committee (IRC) Somalia*

Fellowship City

Nairobi

Fellowship Country

Kenya

Fellowship Start Date

7/29/2025

Anticipated End Date

7/28/2026

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

I entered on a tourist visa. Once I entered the country, IRC applied for an Internship Pass. As of today, that application is still pending. My 90-day tourist visa was extended 60 days, and now expires

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

An eTA is required before entering Kenya. IRC applied for the Internship Pass directly using the documentation I provided.

Did you apply for and receive your visa or permit before going to your host country or after arriving?

Yes, for the tourist eTA.

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

\$30 cost for eTA (reimbursed by IRC). The internship pass application was paid for directly by IRC. \$51 extension of eTA (reimbursed by IRC)

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

They were all covered by IRC

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

Yes

If yes, please explain further

I have still not obtained the Internship Pass, but I am hopeful this challenge will be resolved before my tourist visa expires.

Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

IRC should cultivate better connections in Immigration to speed up the Internship Pass application process.

Fellows from other host organisations in Kenya were able to obtain Internship Passes faster through such contacts. Receiving the Internship Pass sooner is advantageous for a variety of in-country costs, especially for entry fees at parks, wildlife reserves, marine reserves, etc.

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure?

How was your arrival and first week in your host country?